

3D printing methods so that within five years the gap in quality is bridged using advanced 3D printers.

Hobbyists use - The Maker Movement

Just as computers that were once confined to giant rooms became portable devices in user's pockets, the hope for any cutting edge technology is the same - to become part of the household lives of its users. Sometimes this shift takes decades to happen but with 3D printing, the die hard enthusiasm of individuals and small groups is driving consumerisation faster than ever before.

The Maker movement as it is known consists of do-it-yourself enthusiasts and active designers who believe in the potential of 3D printing and are actively pursuing it in their day to day lives. Many of the individuals are hobbyists who consider the freedom and creative innovation of 3D printing to be a liberating form of personal expression as well as a possible source of personal income. The small scale community of Maker's is found even in India as they get together for Maker Meets, the most recent of which took place in Bangalore. And as the prices of home use 3D printers falls within the same range as personal computers more and more hobbyists are becoming part of this movement.

Home and domestic users of 3D printers are able to make an assortment of objects for fun, pleasure and sometimes money. So far the types of objects that have been made by individuals is staggering and include things such as functional clocks, jewelry, household parts like door knobs, coat hooks, bags and even food items. Certain popular instances also include homemade prosthetics, complex toys like abstract Rubik's cubes.

The cheapest models of 3D printers priced between USD \$100 to USD \$500 (cheaper than an iPhone) are being used by individuals for personal



We can look forward to moving away from awkward family photos to awkward family sculptures. 3D printed of course.